DYSANOS

Generative Dynamic Smooth Arbitrage-free Non-parametric Option Surfaces

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Abstract

This article presents with DYSANOS the first generative market model for smooth SANOS option surfaces for all strikes and expiries which are free of static arbitrage. Our model is designed to generate entire paths of daily spot and option prices for years in the future.

We present a robust and useful if somewhat simplistic baseline in the form of an AR(1) model. We discuss model setup, data pipeline, and training and investigate market reconstruction, stability, and tail behavior. We illustrate model performance on 891 Option Metrics IvyDB S&P Index surfaces from 2022 to 2025, drawn from an underlying archive beginning in 2020. With explicit 1D–4D expiry nodes, the two-η affine-200 model places 80.9% of 3.57 million quotes inside bid–ask. Finally, a no-replay scalar log-variance diffusion recovers much more of the observed tail mass and tail persistence than Gaussian innovations, although it still underproduces two- and three-week extremes. Block-randomization tests of decoded 2025 surface paths do not reject Gaussian, heavy-tail, diffusion, or historical-replay candidates at the 5% level.

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1 Introduction

The implied volatility surface of an option market changes dynamically over time, giving rise to Vega risk when risk managing option portfolios. Modelling the dynamics of a full continuous surface of options in a way that is simultaneously *statistically realistic* and *statically arbitrage-free* at every simulated date has remained an open problem since the foundational work of [CFD02] on dynamics of the implied volatility surface.

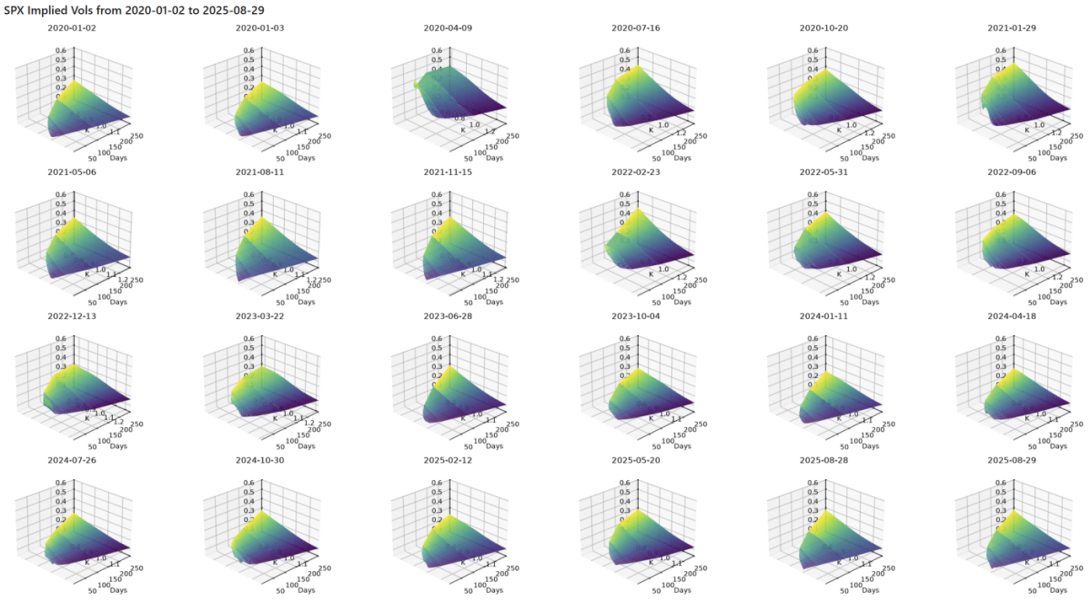


Figure 1: Historical implied volatilities for mid-prices of S&P 500 Index options from 2020-01-02 to 2025-08-29 using Option Metrics Ivy DB data via WRDS `https://wrds-www.wharton.upenn.edu/` (the latest data available at the time of writing).

The most advanced approach until recently were the simulators [WBWB19, WWP+21, CRW23] for realistic dynamics of a *discrete floating grid* of options which are strictly arbitrage-free at each simulation date. These simulators are using, in essence, the discrete local volatility representation pioneered in [BR15] to ensure absence of static arbitrage in every simulated option surface.

However, the restriction of the above models to a discrete set of floating option strikes and time-to-expiries means that the simulators do not have access to the daily returns $dC_t(\tau, k)$ of an actual tradable instruments with cash strikes k and calendar expiries τ (because the contract terms change from one simulated day to another). It therefore does not directly provide statistically consistent time series of fixed-contract returns, which are required to validate simulated dynamics against observed market returns. Of course, since the discrete option prices are free of arbitrage, one option would be to interpolate option prices linearly, which means all options are free of static arbitrage. However, as shown in [Bue06] and illustrated in [BHK+26] linear interpolation yields the most expensive possible arbitrage-free price for any option off the grid, rendering the approach unsuitable in practice. Being linear also means that the implied probability density is piecewise constant and zero between strikes. In other words the spot price can only only take values at the model strikes for each expiry to avoid dynamic arbitrage. This is the reason for the very restrictive and unnatural dynamics in [SW08].
This article presents a model framework for

- **(i) realistic generative dynamics** of
- **(ii) smooth option surfaces for all strikes and expiries** which are
- **(iii) free of static arbitrage**.

This article is a refinement of material presented at The XIII Bachelier World Congress in Bologna.[1]

Historic Context and Literature Review

The classical approach and its limitations. Quantitative finance has traditionally approached this problem by specifying analytically tractable risk-neutral dynamics for the underlying asset — Heston, rough volatility, SABR — and then *calibrating* model parameters to fit each day's option surface independently. In this paradigm, realistic surface dynamics are an afterthought: calibration is repeated from scratch on each date, and inter-day consistency is achieved, if at all, via a local-volatility overlay such as the seminal [GHL12] that lacks interpretable dynamics. This approach is both impractical for large-scale simulation and structurally inconsistent with the goal of generating realistic implied volatility or option price paths.

Why simulating directly in implied-volatility space fails. A natural data-driven alternative is to treat the implied volatility surface itself as the simulation object, much as implied in [CFD02]. The fundamental difficulty is that there is no known parametrization of the implied volatility surface which are free of static arbitrage. If a simulated surface admits a butterfly spread or calendar spread arbitrage, then a learning agent can exploit an artificial profit which is unrelated to the problem for which the generated market was intended. In [CV23], the authors proposed to reduce the probability weights of paths where static arbitage in a simplified form exists; however they do not show that the resulting market is free of arbitrage.

In addition, there are number of recent works such as [NJZB23] which use machine learning methods to learn dynamics of implied volatilities who attempt to impose no-arbitrage via soft constraints; none of them strictly excludes arbitrage. Here, we aim higher and present a framework

[1] https://quantitative-research.de/dl/DYSANOS.pdf

which does not require minutiae daily guesses on penalty weights and other soft parameters to try avoid static arbitrage along simulated paths of years of implied volatilities.

Also, most published works simplify the problem by only considering artificial expiries. SANOS was shown in [BHK+26] to be able to fit entire option surfaces from one day to expiry out to several years. Our model here is a generative version thereof.

Relation to Dupire's local volatility. An intuitive alternative is to use Dupire's local volatility as state space instead *(not as dynamical model)*. Given a non-negative local volatility function $\sigma_t(T,K)$ for $(T,K) \in \mathbb{R}^2_{\geq 0}$ defined on some day t we can define a smooth, strictly arbitrage-free option surface $C_t(T,K) := C^{\mathrm{LV}}(\sigma_t;T,K)$ by solving the Dupire forward-PDE $\partial_T C^{\mathrm{LV}}(\sigma_t;T,K) = \frac{1}{2}K^2\sigma_t^2(T,K)\,\partial^2_{KK}C^{\mathrm{LV}}(\sigma_t;T,K)$. That means any statistical generative model of Dupire's local volatility gives rise to a dynamic model of option surfaces which are by construction free of static arbitrage.

However, in order to price any simulated option off a simulated local volatility surface we would need to solve a forward-PDE on a suitably fine grid which is slow, particularly when used within batch-based gradient descent training.

The idea to address this conundrum is to use a grid of options and define a discrete version of local volatility on that grid, which is what we called *discrete local volatility (DLV)* in [BR15]. However, its native option prices for strikes not on its base grid are the result of linear interpolation and therefore, as mentioned above, "too expensive". We therefore use our smooth SANOS extension [BHK+26].

We also note that in order to find a Dupire local volatility surface for given market data in the first place, we need to fit the market with a smooth arbitrage-free option surface parametrization. Of course, that is what SANOS [BHK+26] was made for but once you have SANOS we might as well use it as the ground truth (since the respective Dupire local volatility will just be another representation of the same surface).

Key contributions

SANOS Decoder:

We show how to implement and learn a coordinate transformation of our SANOS [BHK+26] model such that the state parameters h_t live in $\mathbb{R}^{200}$. A depth-zero affine decoder maps this state into all native DLV, forward-volatility, and forward smoothing coordinates. The call prices remain smooth and statically arbitrage-free.

This "ML-SANOS" is a natural decoder of a driving state process into an option surface of the form

$$h_t \longmapsto C(h_t;T,K)\ .$$

We show how ML-SANOS can be trained directly to suitably pre-processed option market data, yielding a trained h_t for each day. The pre-processing step means that DYSANOS, via SANOS, is fitted to real market bid/ask prices.

Generative Dynamics

We fit a stable 200-dimensional weekly AR(1) directly to the learned surface state. Its transition is parameterized as the matrix exponential of a dissipative generator, and its full innovation covariance is learned by a nonsingular Cholesky factor. The resulting stationary law permits exact Gaussian transitions at daily, weekly, or longer horizons; as non-Gaussian alternatives, a no-replay log-variance diffusion is fitted and historical one-week innovations can be resampled. Although the fitted state has 200 coordinates, decoded implied-volatility variation is strongly concentrated: the first four decoded-IV principal components explain 95.63% for the weekly model and 94.50% for the daily+weekly model.

We do not claim that this approach provides the most realistic dynamics; rather, we see this implementation as baseline to beat with more modern time series models.

Static arbitrage and statistical dynamics

Every decoded SANOS surface is free of static arbitrage by construction. This cross-sectional property does not impose martingale restrictions on fixed-contract returns through simulated time. The present paper studies a historical statistical law and makes no additional dynamic pricing claim.

The completed statistical dynamics and their empirical diagnostics are reported in Section 4.

2 DYSANOS

We consider European call options on a single underlying for historic days $t \in \{t_1, \dots, t_{n^t}\}$. For notational simplicity we assume forwards, discount factors, and default intensities are zero; the extension to non-zero rates and dividends is standard. We comment in remark 4.1 on how to convert market data into driftless data.

We will use boldface for market observables.

We use $\boldsymbol{S}_t$ to denote the (positive) stock price at time t which we assume trades without cost (and therefore has no bid/ask spread). We assume we observe $L_t \in \mathbb{N}$ European call option prices with time-to-expiries $T_t^\ell \geq 0$ and relative strikes $K_t^\ell \geq 0$ for $\ell = 1, \dots, L_t$ in the market. Their payoff is therefore

$$\left(\frac{\boldsymbol{S}_{t+T_t^\ell}}{\boldsymbol{S}_t} - K_t^\ell \right)^+ .$$

We denote by $\boldsymbol{B}_t^\ell$ and $\boldsymbol{A}_t^\ell$ their bid and ask prices; mid-price and half-spread are defined (in vector notation) as $\boldsymbol{C}_t := \frac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{A}_t + \boldsymbol{B}_t)$ and $\boldsymbol{\gamma}_t := \frac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{A}_t - \boldsymbol{B}_t)$. We generally assume that $\boldsymbol{B}_t \succ 0$ and $\boldsymbol{\gamma}_t \succ 0$.[2] Contrary to most derivative literature, we do not assume that bid/ask prices are in some way free of arbitrage; instead we will show how to handle arbitrage valuations gracefully.

The market Black–Scholes implied mid-volatilities $\boldsymbol{\sigma}_t^\ell$ are given by the unique relation $\mathrm{BSCall}(\boldsymbol{S}_t, K_t^\ell, \boldsymbol{\sigma}_t^\ell \sqrt{T_t^\ell}) = \boldsymbol{C}_t^\ell$ in terms of the Black & Scholes call price formula

$$\mathrm{BSCall}(S, K, W) := S\,\mathcal{N}(d_+) - K\,\mathcal{N}(d_-) \quad \text{for} \quad d_\pm := \frac{\log S/K}{W} - \frac{1}{2}W^2 \,. \tag{1}$$

where $\mathcal{N}$ denotes the normal distribution function.

2.1 Arbitrage-Free Call Price Functions

A call price function is simply a function $C : \mathbb{R}^2_{\geq} \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$ which computes call prices $C(T, K)$ for time-to-expiries $T \geq 0$ and relative strikes $K \geq 0$ (i.e. the call prices are normalized to a spot price of 1). The objective of this section and the next is to generate such functions C_t for each simulated date t such that each C_t is "free of static arbitrage" in the following sense:

Definition 2.1. *A call price surface $C : \mathbb{R}^2_{\geq 0} \to \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$ is* statically arbitrage-free *or* free of static arbitrage *if there is no trading strategy which has non-negative returns with a non-zero probability of positive returns.*

Theorem 2.2. *A call price surface C is free of static arbitrage if and only if it does not admit negative butterfly or calendar spreads and satisfies the boundary conditions $C(T, 0) = 1$, $C(0, K) = (1 - K)^+$, $\lim_{K \uparrow \infty} C(T, K) = 0$ and $\partial_K C(T, 0) \in [-1, 0)$.*

The stricter condition $\partial_K C(T, 0) = -1$ applies if the stock price cannot become zero.

[2] We define $x \succ y \Leftrightarrow \forall i : x^i > y^i$.

This has been proven in [BR15]. Here we give a practical guide on how to construct *actionable* arbitrage strategies if any of the above are violated. The simplicity of each of them illustrates the risk of admitting arbitrage in a statistical simulator: such opportunities contaminate the simulated return distribution.

Remark 2.3 (Actionable arbitrage if the conditions of theorem 2.2 are not met)**.** *All of the below are meant as practical heuristics.*

- ***Butterfly arbitrage:*** *this means that the price of a positive butterfly payoff is negative. The arbitrage is to get paid to enter into the butterfly which can only ever generate a positive return.*
- ***Calendar arbitrage:*** *if for the same strike K the call price at T_2 is below the call price at T_1, then:*
  1. *Sell the call at T_1 and buy the call at T_2. This provides a positive cash flow $\pi_0 > 0$.*
  2. *In T_1 if the call expiries out of the money, then we have made money: both π_0 and a potential positive payoff at T_2 in our favour.*
     If the call expires in the money, then we deliver one share and receive K. We are now short that share. In T_2, if the call expiries in the money, then we receive one share to cover our short in return for K. Our total cashflow is π_0. If the call expiries out of the money, then $S_T < K$. We can therefore buy back the share and cover our short for less than K. Our profits are $\pi_0 + (K - S_T)^+ > 0$.
- *If $C(0, K) \neq (1 - K)^+$ we have an immediate pathological arbitrage.*
- *If $C(T, 0) > 1$ then sell the call and cover with one share; if $C(T, 0) < 1$ then buy the call and enter into a short equity position.*
- *$\partial_K C(T, 0) \geq -1$: assume on the contrary there is a $K \downarrow 0$ such that $(1 - C(T, K))/(-K) < -1$ i.e. $C(T, K) = 1 - K - \epsilon$ for some $\epsilon > 0$. Buy the call and short sell the equity, resulting a cash position of $\pi_0 = -K + \epsilon$; the payoff in T is $(S_T - K)^+$ which allows us to cover our position and cash with a total reward of $\epsilon > 0$.*
- *$\partial_K C(T, 0) < 0$: assume on the contrary there is a $K \downarrow 0$ such that $(1 - C(T, K))/(-K) \geq 0$. We show existence of arbitrage in the case of equality i.e. existence of some $K > 0$ such that $C(T, K) = 1$. In that case we sell the call and buy the equity for 1. If the call expires in the money, we deliver the share and receive $K > 0$. If the call expiries out of the money, then sell the share for $S_T \geq 0$.*
- *$\lim_{K \uparrow \infty} C(T, K) = 0$ which means for all $c > 0$ there exists some K such that $C(T, K') < c$ for all $K' \geq K$ (because of convexity). This is the only arbitrage condition which is technical because a violation means, essentially, that the equity can grow without bounds which violates integrability. Assume therefore on the contrary that there is some $c > 0$ such that $C(T, K) \geq c$ for all K. Notice that, formally,*

$$S_T = -\int_0^\infty \frac{(S_T - K + dK)^+ - (S_T - K)^+}{dK} dK = S_T + \lim_{K \uparrow \infty} (S_T - K)^+ .$$

Therefore sell (a discretization of) the strip

$$\int_0^\infty \frac{C(T, K) - C(T, K + dK)}{dK} dK = 1 + e$$

which delivers S_T, and buy the equity. This will generate profits of $e > 0$.

2.2 SANOS - Smooth Arbitrage-free Non-parametric Option Surfaces

In [BHK+26] we introduced a non-parametric family of call price functions which are all statically arbitrage-free. For clarity, let us briefly fix t and drop it from the notation of market data and model parameters.

Each call price function is given in terms of model expiries $0 = \hat{T}^0 < \hat{T}^1 < \cdots < \hat{T}^M$ and, for each model expiry, $N^j > 0$ inner strikes.[3] Including the two boundary strikes, write $\hat{K}^j = (\hat{K}^{j,i})_{i\in\mathcal{I}^j}$ with $\mathcal{I}^j := \{0, \dots, N^j + 1\}$ and $0 < \hat{K}^{j,0} < \cdots < 1 < \cdots < \hat{K}^{j,N^j+1}$. It is recommended that the two outer strikes are far away from the inner strikes.[4] Model strikes and expiries do not need to match market strikes or expiries. We also set $\mathcal{I}^0 = \{0\}$, $\hat{K}^{0,0} = 1$, and $q^{0,0} = 1$; see [BHK+26] for general comments on grid construction.

We say that $q = (q^1, \dots, q^M)$ with $q^j \in \mathbb{R}^{N^j+2}$ is a *martingale density* if it satisfies the linear constraints

$$\begin{cases} \text{Each } q^j \text{ is a density:} & q^j \geq 0,\ (q^j)'1 = 1 \\ \text{Each } q^j \text{ has unit expectation:} & (q^j)'\hat{K}^j = 1 \\ \text{The } q \text{ are in convex order:} & c^j \geq c^{j|j-1} \end{cases} \tag{2}$$

where $c^{j,i} = q^{j\prime}(\hat{K}^j - \hat{K}^{j,i})^+$ is the j-call price for $\hat{K}^{j,i}$, and $c^{j|j-1,i} := q^{j-1\prime}(\hat{K}^{j-1} - \hat{K}^{j,i})^+$ is the $(j-1)$-call price for $\hat{K}^{j,i}$.

Definition 2.4 (SANOS call price)**.** *Let q be a martingale density and $0 < W^1 < \cdots < W^M$ be increasing smoothing total volatilities.*[5] *The SANOS call price for arbitrary $T \geq 0, K \geq 0$ is given by*

$$\begin{aligned} C(T,K) := \alpha^j(T) \sum_{i\in\mathcal{I}^j} \mathrm{BSCall}(\hat{K}^{j,i}, K, W(T)) q^{j,i} \\ + (1-\alpha^j(T)) \sum_{i\in\mathcal{I}^{j-1}} \mathrm{BSCall}(\hat{K}^{j-1,i}, K, W(T)) q^{j-1,i}, \qquad T \in (\hat{T}^{j-1}, \hat{T}^j]. \end{aligned} \tag{3}$$

with $\alpha^j(T) = (T - \hat{T}^{j-1})/(\hat{T}^j - \hat{T}^{j-1})$ and total volatility $W(T) := \alpha^j(T)W^j + (1-\alpha^j(T))W^{j-1}$. For $T > \hat{T}^M$ we set $\alpha^{M+1}(T) = 0$ and $W(T) := W^M\sqrt{T/\hat{T}^M}$; however extrapolation beyond the last model expiry is generally not recommended.

Theorem 2.5. *The call price function C is statically arbitrage-free. For $W(T) > 0$ it is C^∞ in K. The function is as smooth as α in T.*

Remark 2.6. *Contrary to [BHK+26] we interpolated the Black & Scholes backbone in total volatility linearly, not variance. This is a mechanical choice to avoid taking square roots of variables during training which can lead to exploding gradients. If forward volatilities are bounded well away from zero, linear interpolation in variance is suitable, too.*

Remark 2.7. *The Black & Scholes formula in (3) can be replaced by the call price function for any martingale in T, for example the FFT Heston price formula [CM99]. For practical implementations, the function should be fast on a GPU.*

Calibration as a linear program: We assume we obtain $W^1 < \cdots < W^M$ from the market e.g. as square roots of ATM variance per expiry. Given W the model call price $C^\ell := C(T^\ell, K^\ell)$

[3] Note that we changed notation slightly vs. [**?**].

[4] In our experiments, the inner strikes $0 < \hat{K}^{j,1} < \cdots < 1 < \cdots < \hat{K}^{j,N^j}$ were chosen first and then extended by $\hat{K}^{j,0} := \hat{K}^{j,1}/2$ and $\hat{K}^{j,N^j+1} = 1.5\,\hat{K}^{j,N^j}$.

[5] The linear-programming preprocessing uses 50% of ATM total volatility. The trained ML-SANOS decoder instead learns the positive forward smoothing multipliers η^j.

for a market expiry T^ℓ and a market strike K^ℓ can be seen in (3) to be linear in q. The market-fitting problem is therefore the linear programme

$$\min_q \sum_\ell \frac{1}{\boldsymbol{\gamma}^\ell}[(C^\ell - \boldsymbol{A}^\ell)^+ + (\boldsymbol{B}^\ell - C^\ell)^+ + \epsilon|C^\ell - \boldsymbol{M}^\ell|] \tag{4}$$

subject to the linear constraints (2) encoding non-negativity, normalisation, integration to 1, and the inter-expiry convex-order constraints that enforce absence of calendar-spread arbitrage. We note that the model strikes and time-to-expires do not need to correspond to market strikes or expiries.

On S&P 500 Index data with 1000 options across 48 expiries (2-day to 657 business-day TTE), the LP solves in sub-seconds on a desktop PC, achieving 91.4% of options within bid–ask on a representative date (2025-05-06), with a median error of 21% of the half-spread on the remaining options. Figure 2 illustrates the quality of the fit. The example is from [BHK+26]; refer to that work for further details.

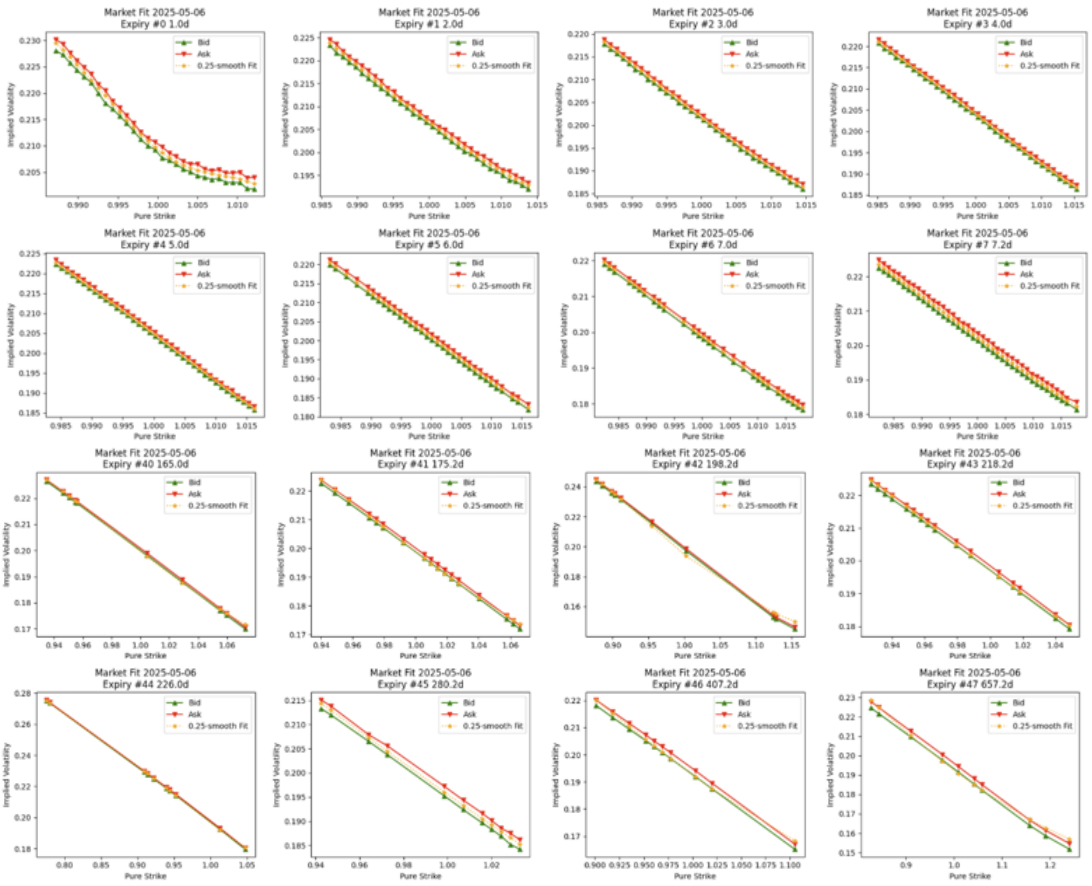


Figure 2: Example fit of SANOS.

3 ML-SANOS

We may view our SANOS call price operator as a map from the model parameters to a function space

$$(q, W;\, \hat{K}, \hat{T}) \overset{\text{SANOS}}{\longmapsto} C \tag{5}$$

for which we naturally want to learn q, W and, as we will see, $\hat{K}$ (as the right strike grid depends on the implied variance of the market). However, the density weights q^j in particular are subject to the linear constraints (2) for which no exact methods exist to integrate them into standard

batch gradient descent methods. In this section we therefore reparameterize the map (5) in terms of learnable parameters.

As a first step we fix a common strike grid $\hat{K}$ with $0 < \hat{K}^0 < \cdots < 1 < \cdots < \hat{K}^{N+1}$ across expiries to simplify our model. The call price for strike $\hat{K}^i$ given the density q^j is given as $c^{j,i} = (q^j)'(\hat{K}^i - \hat{K})^+$. The convex order condition in (2) therefore becomes simply $c^{j,i} \geq c^{j-1,i}$ for all i. Given a martingale density q the squared discrete local volatilities (DLVs) $\Sigma^{j,i} \geq 0$ were defined in [BR15] for the inner indices $i = 1, \ldots, N^j$ via the discrete "backward" Dupire formula[6]

$$\frac{c^{j,i} - c^{j-1,i}}{\hat{T}^j - \hat{T}^{j-1}} \equiv \Sigma^{j,i} \frac{(\hat{K}^i)^2}{(\hat{K}^{i+1} - \hat{K}^i)(\hat{K}^i - \hat{K}^{i-1})} q^{j,i} \tag{6}$$

There is no DLV coordinate at the two boundary indices $i = 0$ and $i = N + 1$ which we set to zero (their density values are determined by the the requirement to add up to 1 and integrate to 1). We also set $\Sigma^{j,i} = 0$ whenever $q^{j,i} = 0$.

The key is that we can reverse this representation. We briefly recall the construction from [BHK+26]: define

$$\omega^{i\pm} := \pm \frac{(\hat{K}^i)^2}{(\hat{K}^{i+1} - \hat{K}^{i-1})\,(\hat{K}^{i\pm1} - \hat{K}^i)} \geq 0$$

and with it the tridiagonal matrix Ω with

- Upper diagonal $(-\omega^{1-}, \ldots, -\omega^{N-}, 0)$,
- Lower diagonal $(0, -\omega^{1+}, \ldots, -\omega^{N^j+})$, and
- Main diagonal $(0, +\omega^{1+} + \omega^{1-}, \ldots, 1 + \omega^{N^j+} + \omega^{N^j-}, 0)$.

i.e.

$$\Omega = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -\omega^{1-} & 0 & & & & \\ 0 & +\omega^{1+} + \omega^{1-} & -\omega^{2-} & & & & \\ 0 & -\omega^{1+} & +\omega^{2+} + \omega^{2-} & & & & \\ & & & \ddots & & & \\ & & & \ddots & & & \\ & & & & +\omega^{(N-1)+} + \omega^{(N-1)-} & -\omega^{N-} & 0 \\ & & & & -\omega^{(N-1)+} & +\omega^{N+} + \omega^{N-} & 0 \\ & & & & 0 & -\omega^{N+} & \end{pmatrix}. \tag{7}$$

Then for *any* squared (discrete) local volatilities $\Sigma^j = (0, \Sigma^{j,1}, \ldots, \Sigma^{j,N^j}, 0)$ the operator

$$1 + \Omega\ \mathrm{diag}(\Sigma^j)(\hat{T}_j - \hat{T}_{j-1}) \in \mathbb{R}^{(N+2)\times(N+2)} \tag{8}$$

is a tridiagonal operator with positive main diagonal and negative off diagonals. As show in [BR15] this operator is invertibe, and the inverse Ξ^j can be efficiently computed on GPU using a compiled Thomas' algorithm. It is also a martingale transition operator in the sense of [BR15] which means that the densities $q^1, \ldots, q^M$ generated iteratively starting in $q^0 = (1)$ by

$$q^j = \Big(1 + \Omega\ \mathrm{diag}(\Sigma^j)(\hat{T}_j - \hat{T}_{j-1})\Big)^{-1} q^{j-1} \tag{9}$$

form a martingale density over $\hat{K}$.

[6] This actually *is* the Dupire formula applied to the implicit forward PDE of the density of a local volatility process, correctly computed on an irregular strike grid; c.f. [BR15].

Remark 3.1. *The operator Ξ^j is the in-homogeneous strike implicit transition operator of the forward-PDE of the continuous time SDE $dS_t = \sqrt{\Sigma_t(K)} S_t \, dW_t$*

$$\frac{dp_t}{dt} = \frac{1}{2} \partial_{KK}^2 (K^2 \Sigma_t p_t) \ .$$

This approach is based on ideas of [AH11].

With the above we have established a map from much simpler non-negative discrete local vols squared to densities, and then to SANOS call prices:

$$(\Sigma, W; \hat{K}, \hat{T}) \overset{\text{DLV}}{\longmapsto} (q, W; \hat{K}, \hat{T}) \overset{\text{SANOS}}{\longmapsto} C \ . \tag{10}$$

That allows us to pass to a practically unconstrained parameter set, which we call the ML-SANOS parametrization. Recall the 1function $\text{sigmoid}(x) = (1 + e^{-x})^{-1}$.

Definition 3.2 (ML-SANOS)**.** *Fix the normalized grid geometry for ML-SANOS with:*

- *Time-to-expiries (TTEs) $0 = \hat{T}^0 < \cdots < \hat{T}^M$ with $\Delta\hat{T}^j = \hat{T}^j - \hat{T}^{j-1}$;*
- *Normalized strikes $z^1 < \cdots < 0 < \cdots < z^N$ which we assume contain zero;*
- *Minimum and maximum forward volatilities $\sigma_{\max} > \sigma_{\min} > 0$;*
- *Minimum and maximum squared discrete local volatilities $\Sigma_{\max} > \Sigma_{\min} > 0$; and*
- *Minimum and maximum smoothing factors $1 > \eta_{\max} > \eta_{\min} \geq 0$.*

We translate the new real-valued ML-SANOS parameters $u = (u^\Sigma, u^\sigma, u^{\eta,\text{f}}, u^{\eta,\text{term}}) \in \mathbb{R}^{M \times N} \times \mathbb{R}^M \times \mathbb{R}^2$ into SANOS parameters as follows:

- *Total volatilities: define the **forward volatilities***

$$\sigma^j := \sigma_{\min} + \text{sigmoid}(u^{\sigma,j})(\sigma_{\max} - \sigma_{\min}) \tag{11}$$

and two smoothing factors

$$\eta^{\text{f}} := \eta_{\min} + (\eta_{\max} - \eta_{\min}) \text{sigmoid}(u^{\eta,\text{f}}) \quad \textit{and} \quad \eta^{\text{term}} := \eta_{\min} + (\eta_{\max} - \eta_{\min}) \text{sigmoid}(u^{\eta,\text{term}}) \ . \tag{12}$$

*With these quantities define the **total volatilities***

$$\widetilde{W}^j := \sum_{\ell=1}^{j} \sigma^\ell \sqrt{\Delta\hat{T}^\ell} \qquad \textit{and} \qquad W^j := \eta^{\text{f}} \sigma^1 \sqrt{\Delta\hat{T}^1} \ + \eta^{\text{term}} \sum_{\ell=2}^{j} \sigma^\ell \sqrt{\Delta\hat{T}^\ell} \ . \tag{13}$$

- *We use $\widetilde{W}^j$ to define a fixed grid as **relative strikes***

$$\hat{K} := \exp\left(z \widetilde{W}^1\right) \bigcup \exp\left(z^i \widetilde{W}^M\right) \ , \tag{14}$$

sufficiently sorted, with boundaries $\hat{K}^0 := \frac{1}{2}\hat{K}^1$ and $\hat{K}^{N+1} := \frac{3}{2}\hat{K}^N$.

- *Finally, we use the new real-valued ML-SANOS parameters to define the **squared discrete local volatilities**:*

$$\Sigma^{j,i} := \min\left\{\Sigma_{\max}, \Sigma_{\min} + \exp(u^{\Sigma,j,i})\right\} \ . \tag{15}$$

(This formulation avoid saturation of the sigmoid function as the raw log-DLV coordinate approaches the cap.) $\Sigma_{\max}$.

Put together, this process describes a map

$$(u; z, \hat{T}) \overset{\substack{\text{ML} \\ \text{SANOS}}}{\longmapsto} (\Sigma, W; \hat{K}, \hat{T}) \overset{\text{DLV}}{\longmapsto} (q, W; \hat{K}, \hat{T}) \overset{\text{SANOS}}{\longmapsto} C \ . \tag{16}$$

In our new parametrization u lives in an unrestricted space and is therefore particularly suited for ML/AI based learning. The expiry locations remain fixed.

3.1 Learning ML-SANOS from real data

Our new parameterization allow the model to fit not only DLV's but also forward volatilities and, via u^η the size of the strike grid for a given set of market data. This extension means the model is no longer linear its parameters. We therefore fit it with stochastic gradient descent methods.

We apply this two two model specifications: one with weekly expiries and one with weekly expires and daily expiries in the front week. The puropose of this comparison is to assess whether a purely weekly model can capture front dynamics natively.

In each case we assess whether an additional compression step on the form of a affine 200 state representation aids learning of dynamic features.

In our experiments we use the bounds $(\Sigma_{\min}, \Sigma_{\max}) = (0.01^2, 3^2)$, $(\sigma_{\min}, \sigma_{\max}) = (0.01, 1)$, and $(\eta_{\min}, \eta_{\max}) = (0.01, 0.50)$. A smooth cap penalty acts on the raw log-DLV coordinate without imposing a saturating upper sigmoid.

Each date uses one floating relative-strike support shared across all model expiries, c.f. (14): half of the 200 normalized-moneyness candidates cover the front expiry and half the final expiry over $(-3, 2)$; after conversion with the date's total-volatility curve they are merged, sorted, and separated by a minimum log-strike gap. The outer support nodes are one half of the first inner strike and one and a half times the final inner strike. The shared strikes means that when solving forward for p we no longer need to regrid

For quote ℓ on date t, let $\widehat{C}_t^\ell$ be the decoded option price, $M_t^\ell = (\boldsymbol{A}_t^\ell + \boldsymbol{B}_t^\ell)/2$, and $\gamma_t^\ell = (\boldsymbol{A}_t^\ell - \boldsymbol{B}_t^\ell)/2$. Decoder fitting minimizes the equal-date-weighted objective

$$\mathcal{L}_t^{\text{quote}} = \frac{1}{L_t} \sum_{\ell=1}^{L_t} \frac{1}{\gamma_t^\ell} \left\{ (\widehat{C}_t^\ell - \boldsymbol{A}_t^\ell)^+ + (\boldsymbol{B}_t^\ell - \widehat{C}_t^\ell)^+ + 0.05 |\widehat{C}_t^\ell - M_t^\ell| \right\} \tag{17}$$

The native controls first fit an independent u_t on every date. The affine-200 model is initialized from those controls and jointly updates b, B, the historical states h_t, and the stable weekly dynamics in Section 4. A gauge penalty fixes the affine non-identifiability by keeping the fitted states at zero sample mean and unit sample covariance.

3.1.1 Affine-200 specialization

The reported models retain the unrestricted-coordinate idea above but make the compression map deliberately transparent. Let $N = 200$ be the number of inner support strikes and M the number of model expiries. For each date the uncompressed state is stored as an expiry-major DLV/forward-volatility block followed by the two smoothing coordinates:

$$u_t = \left(u_t^\Sigma,\, u_t^\sigma,\, u_t^\eta \right) \in \mathbb{R}^{M(N+1)+2}. \tag{18}$$

with $u_t^\Sigma = (u_t^{\Sigma;j,i})_{j=1,i=1}^{M,N}$, $u_t^\sigma = (u_t^{\sigma;j})_{j=1}^{M}$, $u_t^\eta = (u_t^{\eta,\mathrm{f}}, u_t^{\eta,\mathrm{term}})$. The completed decoder has no hidden layers:

$$u_t = b + Bh_t, \qquad h_t \in \mathbb{R}^{200}, \tag{19}$$

where $b \in \mathbb{R}^{M(N+1)+2}$ and $B \in \mathbb{R}^{(M(N+1)+2)\times 200}$. The weekly model has $M = 14$ and therefore 2,816 native coordinates; the daily+weekly model has $M = 18$ and 3,620 native coordinates. The 200 coordinates of h_t are learned latent coordinates, not principal components of implied volatility.[7]

[7] The choice of 200 is an empirical capacity compromise rather than a structural claim about the intrinsic dimension of option surfaces. It is large enough to preserve almost all of the direct native quote fit while remaining below the number of historical dates, so a full innovation covariance and stable joint state dynamics can still be estimated. We report the native-versus-200 fit loss explicitly below rather than treating this dimension as exact.

3.1.2 Data and model geometries

The empirical population contains 891 SPX dates from 2022-01-03 through 2025-08-29. We exclude the 0.2-business-day AM-settled population and retain 3,566,742 call or put quote observations for the weekly geometry and 3,566,258 for the daily+weekly geometry. Calls and puts at the same expiry and strike count as separate observations. The input quote population is retained over normalized moneyness $z \in [-3, 2]$, where z is computed from the arbitrage-free fitted ATM volatility for the corresponding expiry.

Both models use 200 inner strikes over normalized moneyness $z \in (-3, 2)$. They differ only in the internal expiry geometry:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{weekly:} &\quad (5, 10, 15, \ldots, 70) \text{ business days,} \\ \text{daily+weekly:} &\quad (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 10, 15, \ldots, 70) \text{ business days.} \end{aligned}$$

For each geometry we retain a native high-dimensional fit and an affine-200 fit. The native fits isolate the cost of state compression; comparison across geometries isolates the value of explicit short-end expiry nodes.

Inside-spread statistic. For fitted price $\widehat{C}$, bid B, and ask A, define excess in half-spread units by

$$e(\widehat{C}; B, A) := \frac{(\widehat{C} - A)^+ + (B - \widehat{C})^+}{(A - B)/2}. \tag{20}$$

Thus $e = 0$ exactly when the model price lies inside bid–ask. Conditional excess statistics below are computed only over observations with $e > 0$.

3.1.3 Market fit

Table 1 gives the complete quote-population results for the fitted two-η models.

Model	Quotes	Inside bid–ask	Mean excess	Cond. mean	Cond. median
Weekly native	3,566,742	73.2678%	1.1101	4.1525	1.4261
Weekly affine-200	3,566,742	72.8728%	1.1017	4.0612	1.3925
Daily+weekly native	3,566,258	82.2809%	0.3120	1.7609	0.6920
Daily+weekly affine-200	3,566,258	**80.9211%**	0.3229	1.6924	0.6776

Table 1: Aggregate fit. Excess is defined by (20).

Affine compression costs only 0.39 percentage points for the weekly geometry and 1.36 percentage points for the daily+weekly geometry. By contrast, adding the four short-end nodes improves affine-200 fit by 8.05 percentage points. Expiry geometry, not latent-state capacity, is therefore the main bottleneck.

The mechanism is visible directly in table 2.

Model	1D	2D	3D	4D	5D
Weekly native	24.07%	32.47%	42.04%	55.66%	45.45%
Weekly affine-200	24.35%	32.65%	42.11%	55.26%	45.26%
Daily+weekly native	94.56%	95.21%	95.57%	95.77%	68.43%
Daily+weekly affine-200	88.59%	91.98%	93.68%	94.13%	67.58%

Table 2: Inside-spread rates at the five shortest nominal expiries.

The weekly model has no independent 1D–4D state directions and must extrapolate from 5D. The daily+weekly model represents front-end dislocations explicitly.

Figure 3 shows that this is a localized geometry effect, not a general loss of fit. The explicit daily nodes lift the 1D–4D inside-spread rate from roughly 24–55% to 89–94% in the affine model. Once the market expiry is comfortably beyond the first weekly node, the two geometries converge and both approach near-complete containment at the longer end. Within either geometry, the native and affine-200 curves remain close; compression is therefore secondary to where the decoder places its expiry nodes.

The same conclusion appears in the magnitude of misses. Conditional on a quote falling outside the spread, Figure 4 measures its distance in half-spread units. A weekly decoder forced to extrapolate before 5D can miss 1D and 2D quotes by more than ten half-spreads on average; explicit daily nodes reduce that short-end error to roughly one to three half-spreads. The gap narrows rapidly after the first week.

Figure 5 gives a cross-sectional view on 2024-06-14. At representative expiries of 10, 23, 43, and 67 business days, the independently fitted market SANOS surface and the completed weekly affine model track one another closely over the central liquid strike range. The longer-expiry panels also expose a material discrepancy at the far-left boundary; the native-versus-affine IV RMSE is 5.30 and 6.87 volatility points there, compared with 0.12 and 0.30 at 10 and 23 days. The example therefore supports the aggregate fit result while making clear that extrapolative wing coordinates remain a limitation.

Interpretation of the 80% number. The 80.92% headline is the affine-compression reconstruction test over the full 891-date population. After joint fitting of the stable state dynamics, the simulation checkpoint places 81.48% of all quotes inside bid–ask; its 2025 slice contains 707,630 observations and has an 80.56% inside-spread rate. The shared decoder and dynamics used all dates, so the latter is a chronological slice rather than a strict temporal holdout. We interpret it as evidence that the fit is not concentrated in the earlier sample, not as an untouched forecasting estimate.

4 Statistical option-surface state-space model

4.1 Weekly AR(1)

Let h_n be the affine SANOS state sampled at weekly intervals. The fitted statistical law is

$$h_{n+1} = m + A(h_n - m) + \varepsilon_{n+1}, \qquad \mathbb{E}_{\mathbb{P}}[\varepsilon_{n+1} \mid h_n] = 0, \qquad \mathrm{Cov}(\varepsilon_{n+1}) = Q. \tag{21}$$

Rather than fitting an unrestricted discrete transition and checking it after the fact, the model parameterizes

$$\kappa = LL' + S + \kappa_{\min} I, \qquad S' = -S, \qquad A = e^{-\kappa}, \qquad Q = GG', \tag{22}$$

where L is lower triangular, S is unrestricted skew-symmetric, G is lower triangular with strictly positive diagonal, and $\kappa_{\min} = 10^{-3}$ per week. The symmetric part of κ is strictly positive, so every fitted A is stable throughout optimization. The state therefore has a finite invariant covariance P satisfying

$$P = APA' + Q. \tag{23}$$

In Gaussian mode we obtain exact fractional-week transitions. With $A_\Delta = e^{-\kappa\Delta}$,

$$h_{t+\Delta} = m + A_\Delta(h_t - m) + \varepsilon_\Delta, \qquad \varepsilon_\Delta \sim \mathcal{N}(0, Q_\Delta), \qquad Q_\Delta = P - A_\Delta P A'_\Delta. \tag{24}$$

This avoids Euler instability and permits daily, weekly, or longer Gaussian simulation steps from the same fitted weekly law.

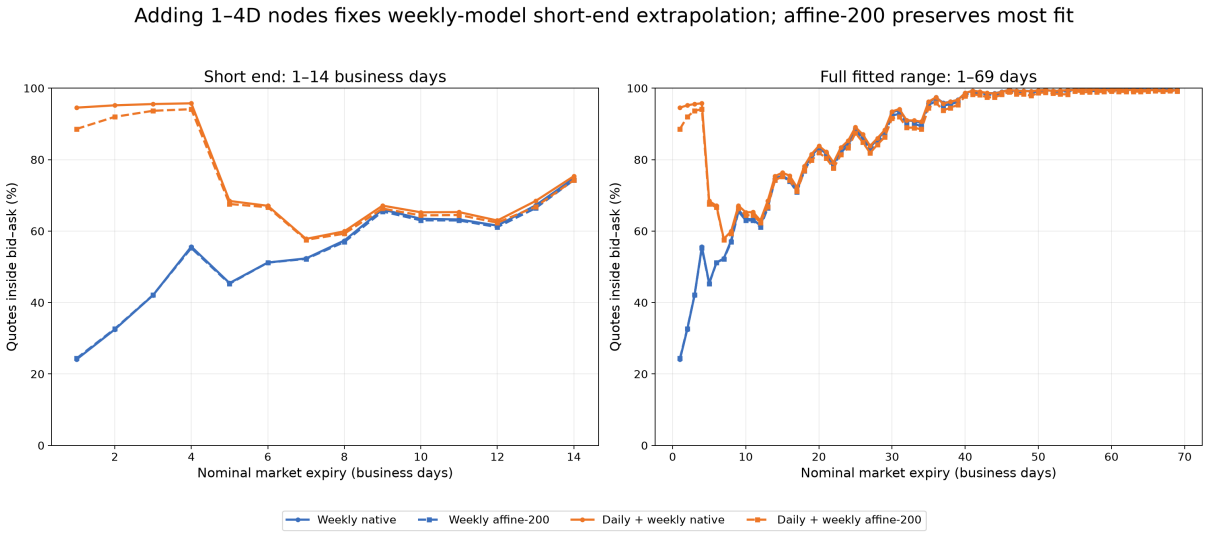


Figure 3: Inside-spread rate by nominal market expiry for the weekly and daily+weekly geometries, before and after affine-200 compression. All quote observations in each expiry bucket are included.

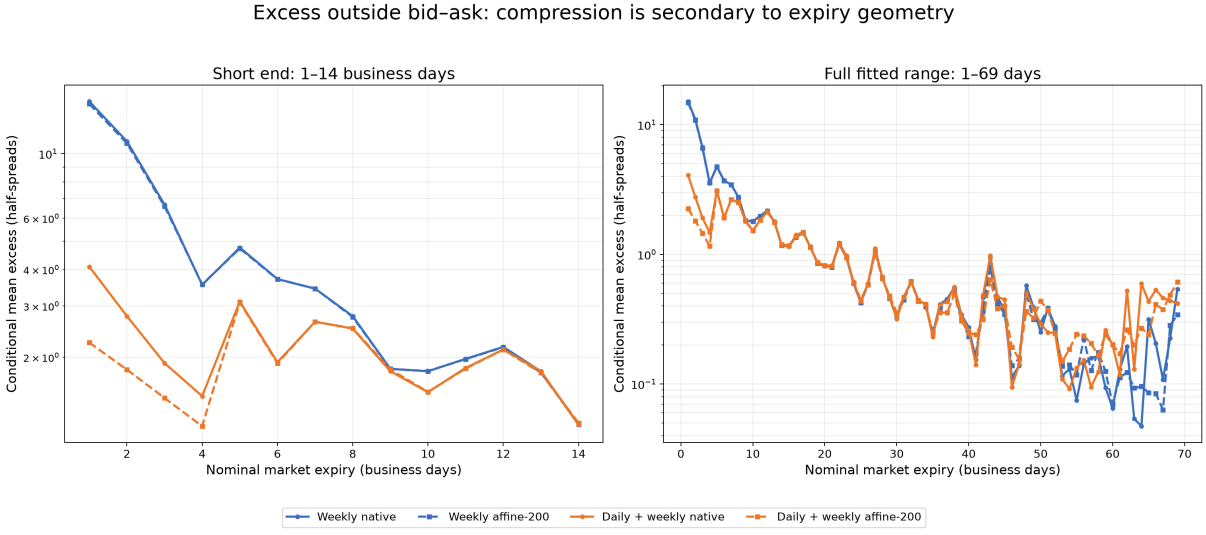


Figure 4: Mean half-spread excess by market expiry, conditional on the model price being outside bid–ask. The logarithmic vertical scale exposes the very large short-end extrapolation errors of the weekly geometry.

4.2 Innovation laws and tail dynamics

Gaussian innovations are a convenient baseline but miss market tails. As a non-parametric comparator we also simulate at weekly steps by independently resampling centered fitted one-week residuals whose endpoints precede 2025. At two and three weeks, independently drawn residuals are propagated through A and summed; no multi-week block is replayed in this tail experiment.

For an exact-horizon state return r with fitted horizon covariance Q^H, define its normalized squared radius

$$(\delta^H)^2 := \frac{r'(Q^H)^{-1}r}{200}. \tag{25}$$

The Gaussian reference would concentrate this quantity sharply around one in 200 dimensions. The observed radii are both heavier-tailed and serially dependent.

4.2.1 No-replay stochastic-volatility diffusion

We therefore add a scalar latent log-variance diffusion without replaying any historical residual. Keeping the affine conditional mean and loading G from $Q = GG'$, the exact weekly transition is

$$\varepsilon_{n+1} = \sqrt{\rho \exp(g_n - v_g/2)}\, G z_{n+1}, \qquad z_{n+1} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, I), \tag{26}$$

$$g_{n+1} = \phi g_n + \sqrt{v_g(1-\phi^2)}\, \xi_{n+1}, \qquad \xi_{n+1} \sim \mathcal{N}(0,1), \tag{27}$$

with independent z_{n+1} and ξ_{n+1}. Stationarity gives $g_n \sim \mathcal{N}(0, v_g)$ and hence $\mathbb{E}[\rho \exp(g_n - v_g/2)] = \rho$. Equation (27) is the exact discrete transition of a stationary Ornstein–Uhlenbeck diffusion; it therefore permits fractional-time simulation without Euler discretization.

The parameters (ρ, ϕ, v_g) are fitted on the 703 pre-2025 one-week innovations. Since

$$\log(\delta_n^2) = \log \rho + g_n - v_g/2 + \log(\chi^2_{200}/200), \tag{28}$$

we use a Kalman likelihood whose measurement mean and variance are the exact first two moments of $\log(\chi^2_{200}/200)$; only its Gaussian shape is an approximation. The weekly fit gives $(\rho, \phi, v_g) = (0.872, 0.249, 0.0556)$, and the daily+weekly fit gives $(0.878, 0.139, 0.0649)$. On the 158 2025 innovations, log-radius negative log likelihood falls from 1.986 to 0.089 in the weekly model and from 2.453 to 0.125 in the daily+weekly model relative to a pre-2025-scaled Gaussian benchmark.

For comparison we also fit variance-normalized multivariate Student-t innovations, either IID or with a persistent score-driven common scale. The fitted degrees of freedom are 42.6 and 34.5. On the same 2025 innovations the score-driven law reduces full-vector negative log likelihood per dimension from 1.377 to 1.364 in the weekly geometry and from 1.351 to 1.332 in the daily+weekly geometry; the improvement over IID Student-t is negligible.

Table 3 reports the probability of exceeding the pre-2025 empirical 95% radius at each horizon. "Market" is the realized 2025 rate; every simulated estimate uses one million paths.

Geometry	Innovation law	1W	2W	3W
Weekly	2025 market	5.063%	5.696%	5.696%
	Gaussian	0.1470%	0.00439%	0.00539%
	IID Student-t	4.350%	1.275%	1.164%
	Score-driven Student-t	4.523%	1.542%	1.435%
	Log-variance diffusion	3.960%	1.153%	1.032%
	Independent historical replay	5.143%	2.444%	2.386%
Daily+weekly	2025 market	6.329%	6.329%	5.696%
	Gaussian	0.0318%	0.000140%	0.000133%
	IID Student-t	4.139%	0.986%	0.856%
	Score-driven Student-t	4.119%	1.071%	0.931%
	Log-variance diffusion	3.751%	0.778%	0.659%
	Independent historical replay	5.150%	2.412%	2.318%

Table 3: Probability of exceeding the pre-2025 market 95% normalized-radius threshold. Market frequencies use 158 2025 transitions; simulation uses one million paths per law.

The no-replay diffusion is therefore a meaningful improvement, not a complete tail model. It also produces squared-radius serial correlations of 0.206 and 0.116, compared with 0.133 and 0.091 in the weekly and daily+weekly market histories; Gaussian and IID laws have zero population correlation. The 2025 sample is small and overlapping: 15-origin circular-block bootstrap 95% intervals for the market exceedance rates are approximately 0.6–14.6% across the six geometry/horizon cells. Differences of a percentage point should therefore not be over-interpreted. Independent historical replay is still closest in marginal tail mass, while the diffusion is a fully parametric generator with fresh support and explicit persistence.

4.3 Chronological surface-path comparison

Horizon radii test the latent innovation law but do not directly test paths of decoded option prices. We therefore form every available sequence of four fitted market-state surfaces separated by one full trading week, giving three consecutive weekly changes. Here "observed" means the date-specific latent state fitted to that day's irregular quote book and then passed through the common SANOS decoder; it is not a second interpolation of the raw quotes. Every candidate simulator starts from that fitted surface at the same origin date. Its path features are changes in normalized call prices on the Cartesian panel of target locations

$$T \in \{1, 5, 10, 20, 40, 70\} \text{ business days}, \qquad K/S \in \{0.85, 0.90, 0.95, 1.00, 1.05, 1.10, 1.15\}.$$

Each target expiry is mapped to the closest distinct model expiry. The daily+weekly geometry therefore has $3 \times 6 \times 7 = 126$ features; in the weekly geometry the 1D and 5D targets both map to 5D, leaving $3 \times 5 \times 7 = 105$. Coordinates are centered and scaled using pre-2025 observed paths only.

For this path-level test, the historical comparator replays an entire pre-2025 three-week sequence of fitted residuals, rather than drawing its three weekly residuals independently. It is therefore a deliberately strong finite-sample benchmark that preserves short-run clustering, but it is not a new parametric law and cannot generate innovations outside the stored blocks.

We report the standardized energy distance and an unbiased Gaussian-kernel maximum mean discrepancy (MMD) between observed and simulated 2025 paths. For the null distribution, entire paired chronological blocks of 15 origin dates swap their observed/simulated labels; the block length matches the three-week feature horizon and retains most overlap-induced dependence. 1,999 random block swaps give a Monte Carlo p-value with minimum positive resolution 0.0005.

The 2025 split is a chronological holdout for fitting any auxiliary tail law, constructing a historical-residual pool, and estimating the feature standardization. The shared affine decoder

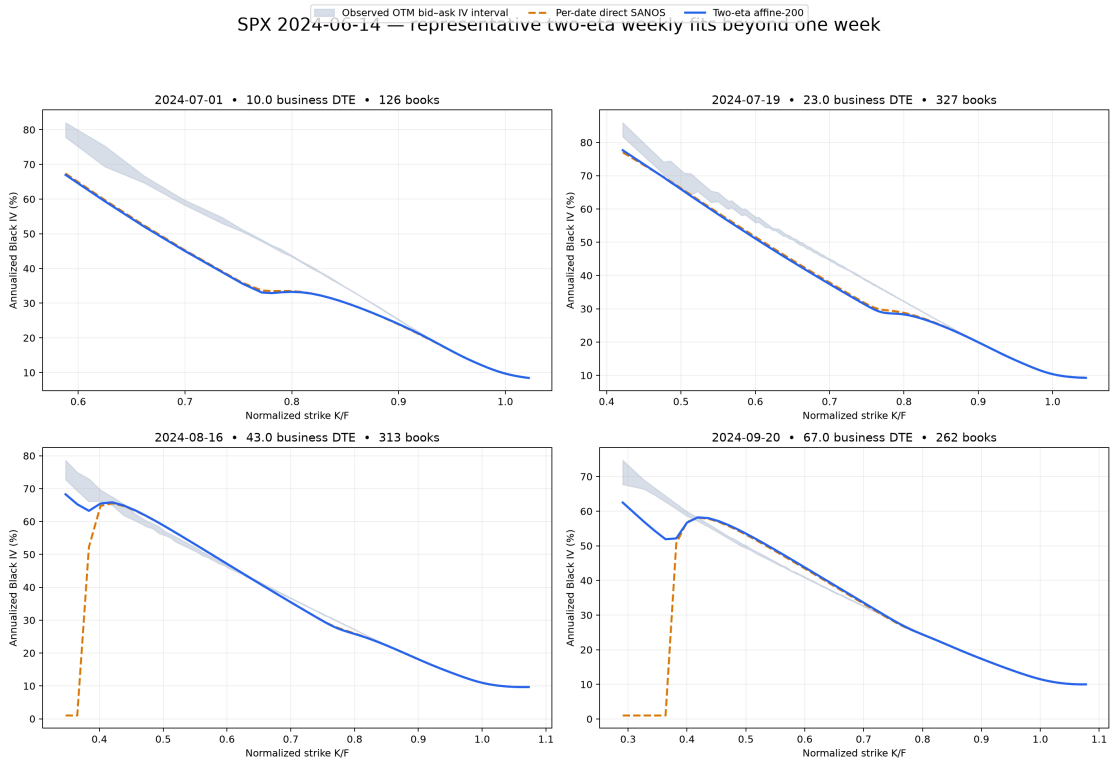


Figure 5: Representative SPX fit on 2024-06-14. The panels compare observed OTM bid–ask implied-volatility intervals, the per-date SANOS preprocessing fit, and the affine weekly model at four market expiries.

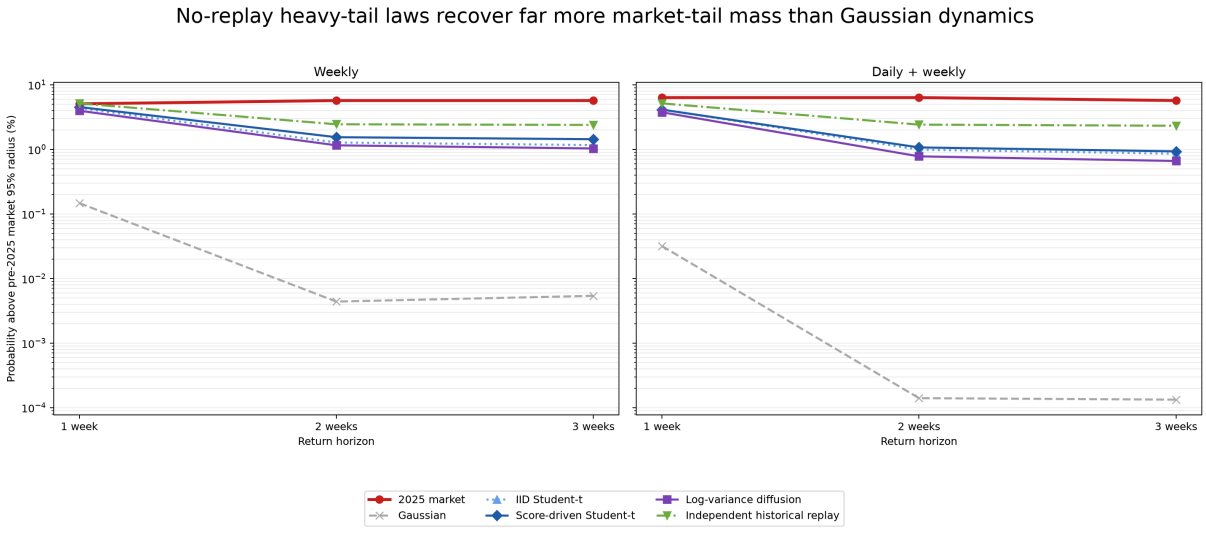


Figure 6: Probability of exceeding the pre-2025 market 95% normalized-radius threshold, on a logarithmic scale. Both no-replay heavy-tail laws recover orders of magnitude more tail mass than Gaussian innovations but remain too light at two and three weeks.

and the baseline Gaussian AR law are nevertheless taken from the all-history checkpoint. The path comparison is therefore a holdout diagnostic for the innovation-law extensions conditional on the learned representation, not a fully frozen pre-2025 model forecast.

Table 4 reports 144 paired 2025 paths for each geometry. The p-value is the block-swap test for MMD; energy distance is reported as a second scale-sensitive discrepancy. None of the five candidates is rejected at 5%. This is evidence against a gross path-distribution failure, but not a ranking theorem: IID Student-t has the smallest weekly energy distance, whereas Gaussian has the smallest daily+weekly energy and MMD. The log-variance diffusion remains statistically plausible while improving the separate tail and persistence diagnostics above.

	Weekly			Daily+weekly		
Innovation law	Energy	$10^3\times\text{MMD}^2$	p	Energy	$10^3\times\text{MMD}^2$	p
Gaussian	0.572	4.602	0.550	0.810	1.594	0.704
IID Student-t	0.540	5.016	0.344	0.854	3.788	0.457
Score-driven Student-t	0.569	4.389	0.225	0.838	3.786	0.416
Log-variance diffusion	0.606	5.476	0.378	0.854	3.480	0.415
Historical block replay	0.592	6.671	0.328	0.857	6.968	0.345

Table 4: Chronological decoded-surface path diagnostics on 144 paired 2025 origins. Each path contains three consecutive weekly changes; p is based on 1,999 paired 15-origin block swaps.

4.4 Stability diagnostics

Statistic	Weekly	Daily+weekly
State dimension	200	200
Dates	891	891
Exact 1W innovations	861	861
$\rho(A)$	0.9577	0.9561
Slowest-mode half-life	16.1 weeks	15.4 weeks
Minimum real eigenvalue of κ	0.0432	0.0449
Invariant covariance condition number	3.51	3.64
Invariant covariance effective rank	196.5	196.4

Table 5: Fitted state-law diagnostics.

Both laws are stable and retain almost full effective rank in state space. A simulator can therefore start from an observed state or draw $h_0 \sim \mathcal{N}(m, P)$ when a stationary initialization is appropriate.

4.5 Conditional front-expiry spot block

Remark 4.1 (Normalization with forwards and discount factors)**.** *If the market has discount factors $\boldsymbol{DF}_t(T) = \exp(-R_t(T))$ and forwards $\boldsymbol{F}_t(T) = \boldsymbol{S}_t \exp(R_t(T) - D_t(T))$, the normalized one-step log-spot return is*

$$\Delta s_{t+1} = \log \boldsymbol{S}_{t+1} - \log\big(\boldsymbol{DF}_t(\Delta t)\boldsymbol{F}_t(\Delta t)\big) = \log \boldsymbol{S}_{t+1} - \log \boldsymbol{S}_t + D_t(\Delta t).$$

Option prices require no further drift adjustment here because the input surface has already been expressed in forward- and discount-normalized units.

The normalized option surface can be simulated autonomously. Cash spot is attached through the front-expiry SANOS distribution while preserving its observed contemporaneous dependence

with surface innovations. Let F_t^1 denote the CDF obtained from the first decoded SANOS density, including the lognormal backbone, and let z_{t+1} be the whitened one-session state innovation. Each observed gross spot return is transformed to its front-law Gaussian score

$$g_{t+1} = \Phi^{-1}\left[F_t^1\left(\frac{S_{t+1}}{S_t}\right)\right]. \tag{29}$$

On transitions preceding the evaluation window, we estimate a ridge loading b by regressing the standardized g_{t+1} on z_{t+1}. Its penalty is selected by time-ordered validation. If $\sigma_\perp$ is the fitted residual standard deviation, a joint scenario uses independent standard normals $Z \in \mathbb{R}^{200}$ and $\epsilon \in \mathbb{R}$ and sets

$$G = \frac{b'Z + \sigma_\perp \epsilon}{\sqrt{b'b + \sigma_\perp^2}}, \qquad \frac{S_{t+1}}{S_t} = (F_t^1)^{-1}(\Phi(G)). \tag{30}$$

The same Z drives the next surface state. Consequently the spot draw has the current front-expiry marginal and the fitted spot–surface copula rather than being independent of the surface shock. For each date we tabulate F_t^1 on a fine log-return grid and invert it with a monotone PCHIP spline. This is an interpolation of the quantile function; it avoids a separate root solve for every scenario without sacrificing monotonicity. Log-spot itself is not part of the invariant surface state.

Because F_t^1 is the option-implied risk-neutral front-expiry marginal, this construction does not estimate or add a physical spot drift. Its first moment is fixed by the observed front forward (and equals one in forward-normalized units), so spot carries the one-step risk-neutral drift implied by market carry. The fitted copula changes only the dependence between spot and surface innovations; it does not change the spot marginal or its drift.

4.6 Decoded implied-volatility geometry

Although h_t has 200 coordinates, decoded implied-volatility variation is much lower-dimensional. We differentiate the affine SANOS decoder at the invariant mean and combine its Jacobian with P. The resulting PCs are directions in decoded implied-volatility space, not the learned state coordinates.

Cumulative decoded-IV variance	Weekly	Daily+weekly
PC1	74.85%	77.68%
PC1–2	86.97%	86.98%
PC1–4	95.63%	94.50%
PC1–8	99.46%	99.39%

Table 6: Decoded implied-volatility variance under the invariant state law.

Figure 7 gives the full leading spectrum. PC1 is a nearly parallel volatility-level move and explains 74.85% of weekly decoded variance and 77.68% of daily+weekly decoded variance. Four decoded-IV factors explain 95.63% and 94.50%, respectively. This does not imply that four latent coordinates would fit the quote book: the PCA is performed *after* the 200-state model has been passed through the nonlinear SANOS decoder and weighted by its invariant covariance.

The invariant means in Figure 8 are the natural "base volatility" surfaces of the two statistical models. Their broad term-structure and skew geometry is similar. The difference is concentrated at the front: the daily+weekly model has four additional expiry slices with independent DLV and forward-volatility coordinates, whereas the weekly model extrapolates from 5D.

Figures 9 and 10 show the first eight eigensurfaces. Each panel is one invariant standard deviation and has its own vertical scale; PCA signs are arbitrary. PC1 is the global level. PC2 is primarily a broad skew/term-structure rotation, while PC3 couples skew and maturity. Higher

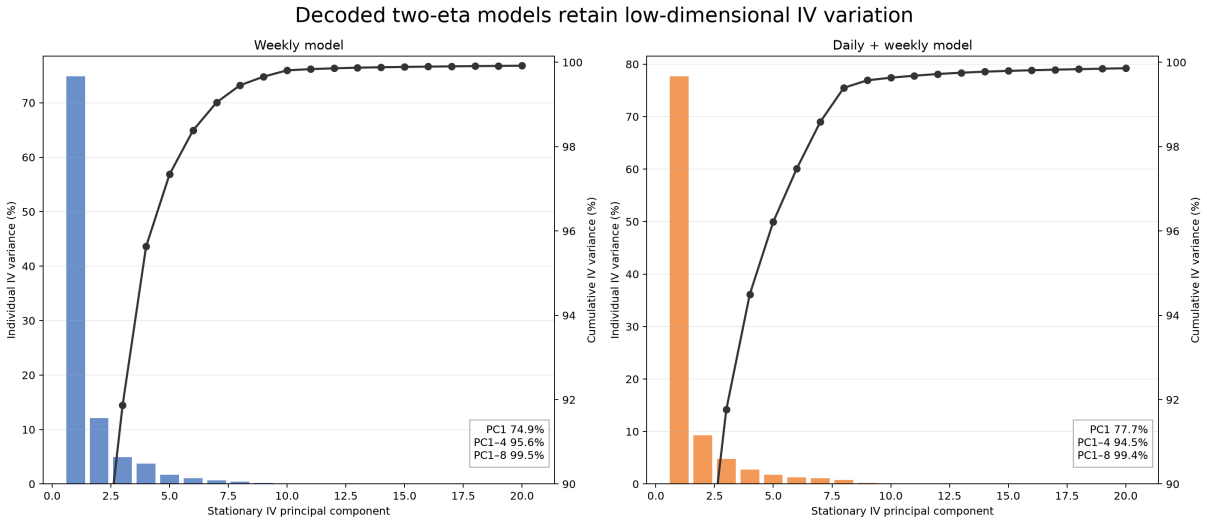


Figure 7: Variance explained by PCA of decoded implied-volatility levels under the fitted invariant state laws. The 200 affine coordinates are not themselves these PCs.

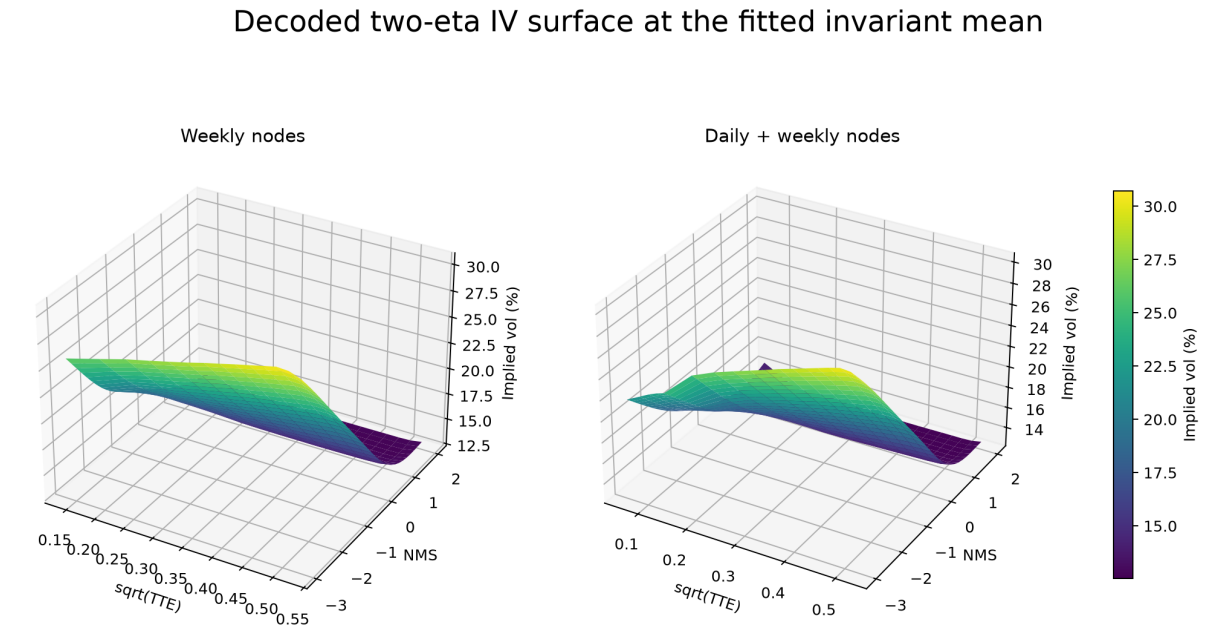


Figure 8: Base implied-volatility surfaces, obtained by evaluating each affine SANOS decoder at the invariant state mean. Axes are square-root time-to-expiry, normalized moneyness, and annualized implied volatility.

modes become increasingly localized. The daily+weekly model places visibly more of those localized modes at 1D–4D, which is precisely the flexibility needed to fit the front-end quote book.

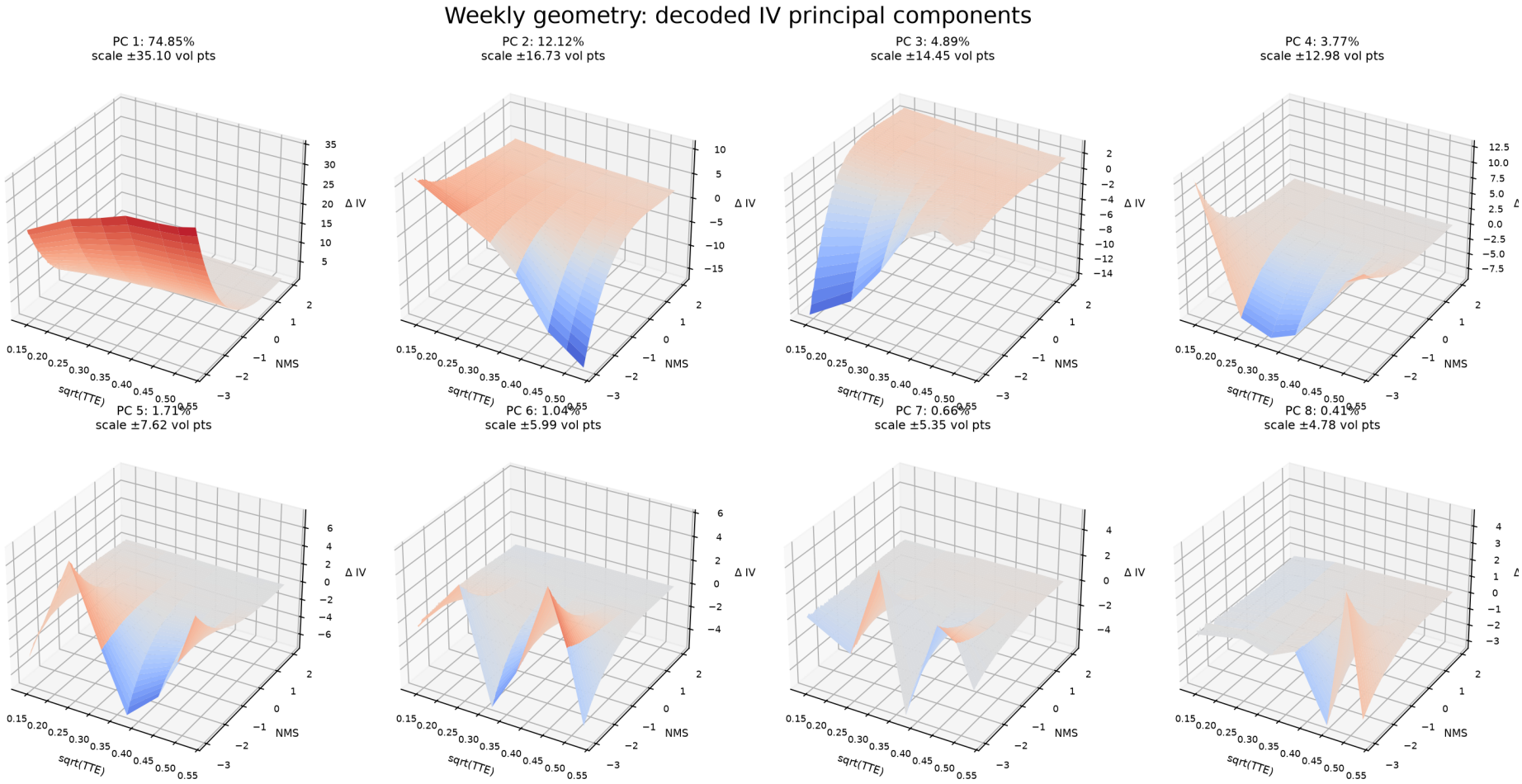


Figure 9: Weekly geometry: decoded implied-volatility PCs 1–8 at one invariant standard deviation. The title of each panel reports explained variance and the panel-specific move in volatility points.

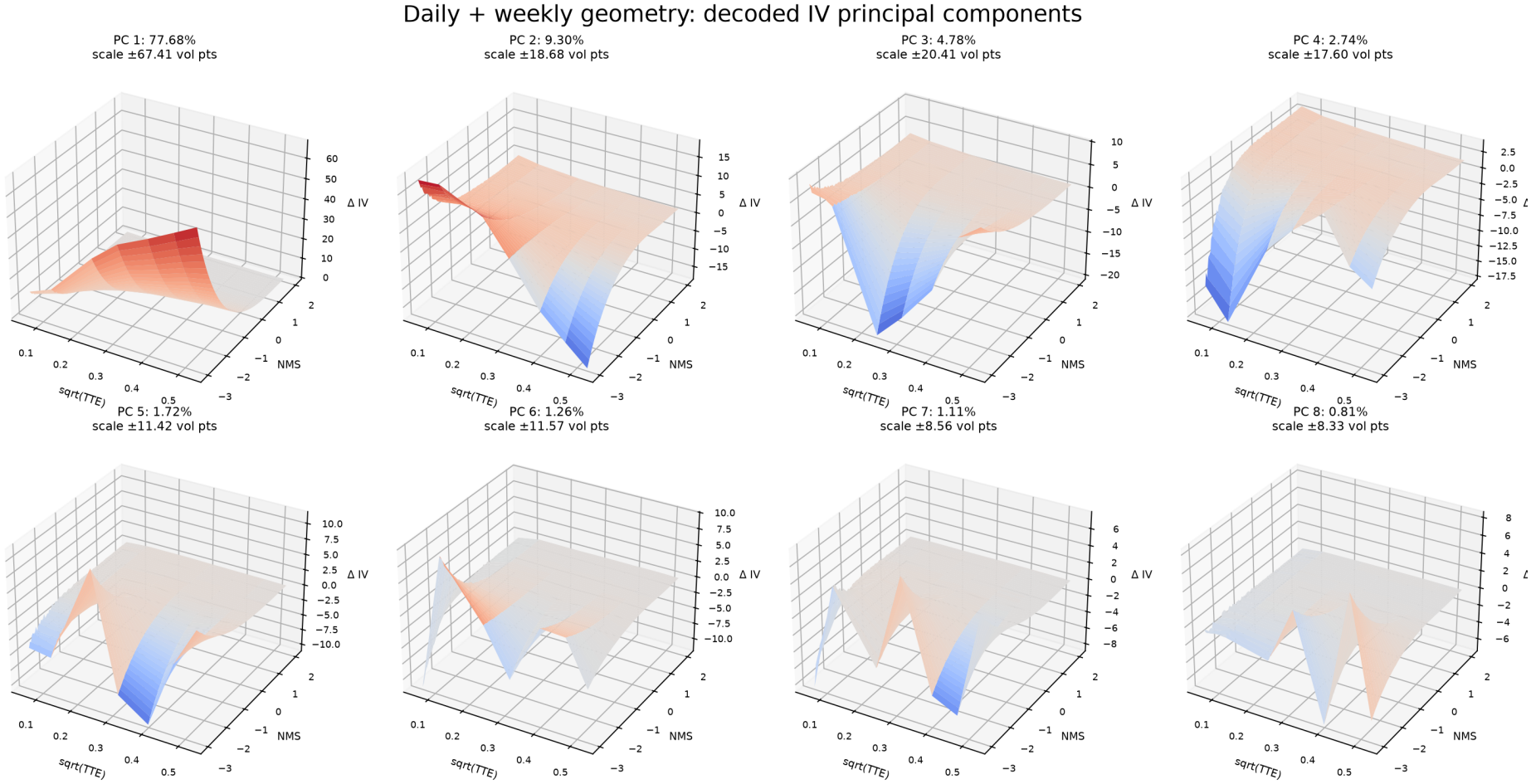


Figure 10: Daily+weekly geometry: decoded implied-volatility PCs 1–8 at one invariant standard deviation. Additional front-end modes appear because 1D–4D are explicit model expiries.

4.6.1 Invariant-distribution visualization

The PCA summarizes local covariance at the invariant mean; complete nonlinear decodes verify what that covariance produces as a surface distribution. Figure 11 shows six independent draws from each fitted $\mathcal{N}(m, P)$ state law. The weekly model's sub-5D ATM term structure is visibly constrained by extrapolation from its first node. The daily+weekly model can generate sharp but still statically admissible front-end dislocations.

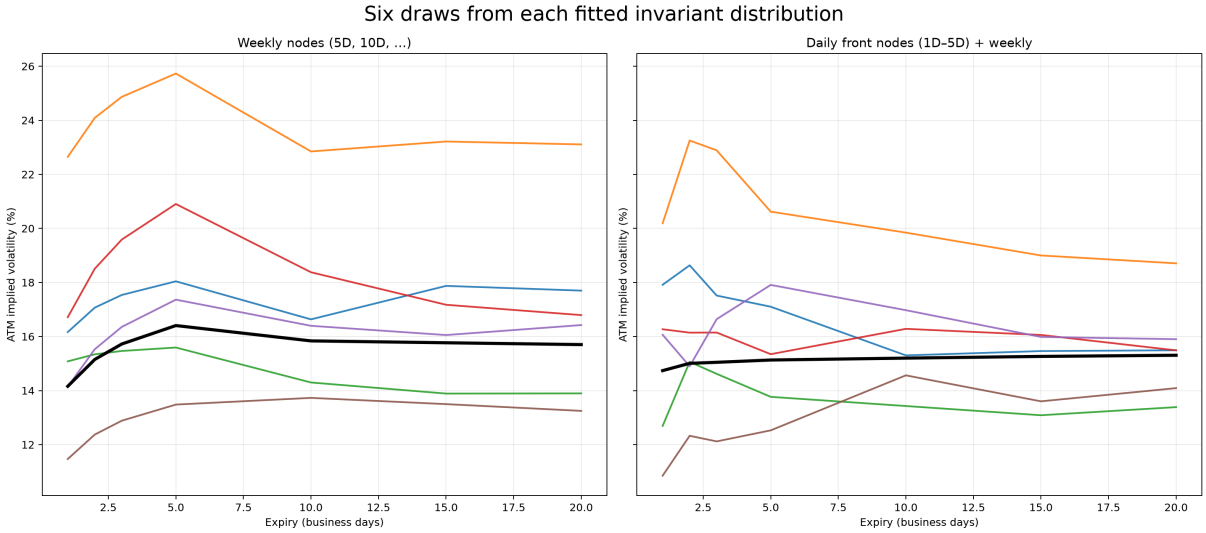


Figure 11: ATM implied-volatility term structures from six independent invariant-state draws for each model. Black is the invariant-mean decode. These are stationary cross-sectional samples, not consecutive time steps.

Figure 12 uses the same 200-dimensional standard-normal seed for both models, mapped through each model's own invariant covariance and decoder. It provides a controlled visual comparison of complete draws: their long-end shapes remain broadly comparable, while the daily+weekly surface has materially richer short-end geometry.

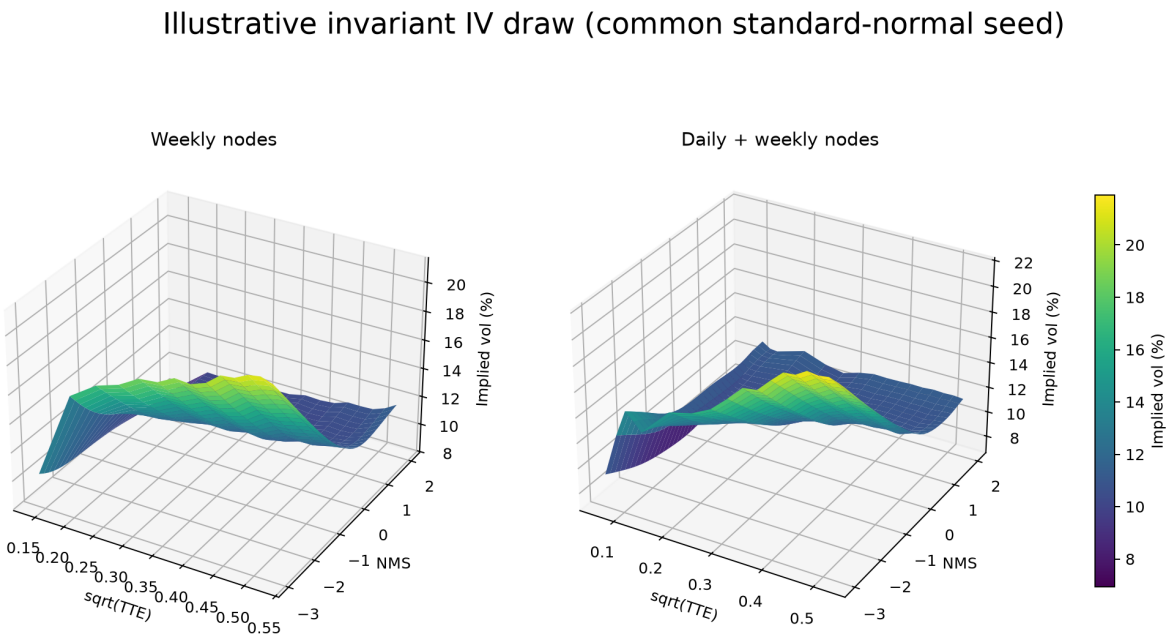


Figure 12: Paired complete invariant-state surface draws. A common standard normal seed is transformed by each fitted invariant covariance before being decoded by the corresponding affine SANOS model.

4.7 Simulation algorithm

The statistical DYSANOS simulator is summarized as follows.

1. Choose the daily+weekly geometry and initialize h_0 from an observed date or from the invariant state distribution.
2. Propagate the state with the exact Gaussian transition (24), or use the no-replay log-variance diffusion (26)–(27) when persistent tails are required. Historical innovation replay remains a non-parametric weekly benchmark.
3. If cash prices are required, propagate s_t conditionally using (30).
4. Form $u_t = b + Bh_t$, map it to bounded SANOS parameters through (15) and (13), and apply the density recursion of Section 3.
5. Evaluate $C_t(T, K)$ at any desired strike and expiry. For a fixed cash contract (τ, k) use $T = \tau - t$ and $K = k/S_t$.

The AR transition and SANOS decoder serve different roles. Stability of the first supplies a coherent long-run statistical state process; the second guarantees a valid option cross-section for every realized state. The combination is what we mean by consistent $\mathbb{P}$-simulation in this paper.

4.8 Fixed-sample to-expiry entropy projection

As a finite-sample diagnostic, we ask whether the simulated law can be reweighted so that a rolling option book has no expected return outside an explicit transaction-cost band. Both experiments use one historical initial state (25 October 2023) and $N = 1{,}000{,}000$ antithetic simulated paths. Each option has a fixed cash strike set on its entry date and is held to its terminal payoff. The admissible expected-return band is 1bp for spot and 10bp for each option, representing symmetric entry costs.

We considered two nested books. The pilot book contains spot and, for each of 5D, 10D, 15D, and 20D, a call struck at $K/S_t = 0.99$, an ATM call, and a put struck at $K/S_t = 1.01$. Repeating these 13 instruments on each of 25 entry dates gives $25 \times 13 = 325$ return coordinates.

The expanded book replaces those three options by 11 normalized-moneyness coordinates at every expiry,

$$z \in \{-1.5, -1.3, -1.1, -0.9, -0.7, -0.5, -0.3, -0.1, 0.1, 0.3, 0.5\}. \tag{31}$$

At entry time t, normalized moneyness z is converted to the cash strike

$$K = S_t \exp\big(z\,\nu_t(T)\big), \qquad \nu_t(T) = \sqrt{\frac{\sigma_{t,\epsilon}^2 \epsilon + \widetilde{W}_t(T)^2}{1+\epsilon}}, \tag{32}$$

where $\widetilde{W}_t(T)$ is the strike-grid total volatility from (13), $\sigma_{t,\epsilon} = \widetilde{W}_t(\hat{T}^1)/\sqrt{\hat{T}^1}$, and ϵ is the canonical small-time regularization. Negative-z contracts are ITM calls and positive-z contracts are ITM puts. The grid in (31) deliberately does not contain zero, so this expanded book has no ATM option. With spot and 4×11 options at each entry date it has $25 \times 45 = 1{,}125$ return coordinates.

Let $R_n \in \mathbb{R}^d$ be the return vector on path n, where $d \in \{325, 1{,}125\}$, let $c \in \mathbb{R}^d_+$ be the cost band, and let w_n denote an empirical density relative to the uniformly weighted simulation

sample. We solve the convex information projection

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{w_1,\dots,w_N>0} \quad & \frac{1}{N}\sum_{n=1}^{N} w_n \log w_n, \\ \text{subject to} \quad & \frac{1}{N}\sum_{n=1}^{N} w_n = 1, \\ & -c \;\le\; \frac{1}{N}\sum_{n=1}^{N} w_n R_n \;\le\; c. \end{aligned} \tag{33}$$

The dual is a signed entropic OCE objective. We solve it with an active-set method and streamed log-sum-exp evaluations, so the complete million-path return matrix need not be copied into the optimizer.

Diagnostic	Three-option pilot	11-option NMS book
Paths	1,000,000	1,000,000
Options per expiry	3	11
Return coordinates	325	1,125
Active coordinates	207	336
Relative entropy $N^{-1}\sum_n w_n \log w_n$	0.0619141	0.1130914
Effective sample size	877,973 (87.80%)	765,493 (76.55%)
Minimum density weight	0.00880	0.00286
Maximum density weight	36.42	84.17
Zero density weights	0	0
Maximum cost-band violation	8.45×10^{-8}	3.15×10^{-8}
Maximum KKT residual	8.45×10^{-8}	3.53×10^{-8}
Primal–dual gap	7.14×10^{-9}	3.37×10^{-9}

Table 7: In-sample convex entropy projection for rolling to-expiry returns. Residuals are in return units. The maximum cost-band violations are 0.000845bp and 0.000315bp, respectively.

All fitted weights are strictly positive. The expanded book retains 76.55% of the original effective sample size despite imposing 1,125 moment bands. For both books the optimizer terminated during its final line search rather than returning its strict success flag. The independently recomputed primal, KKT, and primal–dual residuals in Table 7 show that the economically relevant cost-band constraints are nevertheless satisfied to substantially less than one thousandth of a basis point.

This is deliberately an *in-sample, unconditional* statement. The weights solve empirical moment constraints for this initial state and this fixed path population. They do not prove the existence of a single state-conditional transition density, do not constitute an out-of-sample forecast, and do not alter the statistical dynamics used elsewhere in the paper. The experiment nevertheless establishes that the selected finite book is compatible with a well-conditioned, absolutely continuous empirical reweighting when contracts are evaluated to expiry.

4.9 Scope and limitations

The 80.92% market-fit figure is computed on the population used to estimate the final all-history model. It is not a claim of 80% future forecast coverage. A formal forecasting study should freeze the decoder and dynamics before the evaluation period.

The Gaussian state law severely understates tail frequency. The no-replay log-variance diffusion improves likelihood, tail mass, and serial-tail dependence, but still underproduces two- and three-week extremes. Historical innovation replay is closer in marginal tail mass, while the path-level tests have only 144 overlapping 2025 origins and do not distinguish the candidates sharply. A richer multiscale or regime-dependent volatility law is the most direct next extension.

Finally, static arbitrage-freedom is a property of each decoded surface. It does not by itself impose restrictions on expected returns of fixed contracts through simulated time. The fixed-sample entropy projection in Section 4.8 is an unconditional diagnostic for one finite simulated population, not an additional dynamic pricing assertion.

5 Conclusion

We presented with DYSANOS the first generative option market model built from smooth, strictly statically arbitrage-free SANOS surfaces. Our approach does not rely on approximate static constraints; each smooth option surface is strictly arbitrage free and allows pricing of any option on GPU. We have shown how to leverage our representation to build a simple, but already fairly powerful baseline model which can generate spot and option paths for many days in the future up to years. The surface-first AR(1) captures first-order level, skew, term, and leverage effects. Its front and term smoothing coordinates allow the short end to move separately from later expiries, and the daily+weekly affine model places 80.92% of the full quote population inside bid–ask. A no-replay log-variance diffusion improves the deficient Gaussian tail law and reproduces tail persistence, although multi-week tail mass remains too low. The decoded-surface path diagnostics do not reject any of the Gaussian, heavy-tail, diffusion, or replay candidates at the 5% level, although their power is limited by the 144 available overlapping origins. For one million simulated paths from a representative initial state, a convex entropy projection of 1,125 rolling to-expiry return coordinates remains well-conditioned (76.55% ESS), retains strictly positive weights, and satisfies the stated transaction-cost bands to less than 0.001bp in sample.

We have provided a baseline model to generate long paths of daily spot and option prices. Each option surface is free of static arbitrage. Moreover, we can price *any* option on each path given the ML-SANOS parameters for the respective sample and time step. The resulting paths therefore provide statistically consistent prices for arbitrary fixed cash contracts rather than only for a preselected finite set.

6 Thanks

We want to thank the team at Wharton for their WRDS https://wrds-www.wharton.upenn.edu portal and Option Metrics https://optionmetrics.com/united-states for providing their IvyDB data via this service. Without this data our work would not have been possible.

A Appendix: Data Pipeline

In the interest of full transparency we here discuss main elements of the data pipeline used in our experiments.

The market-data pipeline constructs a standardized daily time series of SPX option surfaces. Raw option quotes are cleaned, normalized, filtered, checked against an arbitrage-free reference surface, and finally collected into irregular quote books suitable for direct model training.

The pipeline processes SPX option data between January 2nd, 2020 and August 29th, 2025. The latter is the latest day available at the time of writing. Only valid full-day NYSE trading days are considered.

A.1 Pipeline Overview

The complete transformation can be summarized as

$$\begin{aligned}\text{raw SPX option quotes} &\longrightarrow \text{daily cleaning and enrichment}\\ &\longrightarrow \text{arbitrage-free quote surface using linear SANOS}\\ &\longrightarrow \text{liquidity and moneyness filters}\\ &\longrightarrow \text{shared 200-strike SANOS model geometry}\\ &\longrightarrow \text{direct native and affine-200 quote fits.}\end{aligned}$$

The key insight when working with Option Metrics IvyDB data is that the forward curves from the `Forward_Price` table do not line up with the option data themselves. We therefore compute our own forward from weighted put-call parities. We also convert the tightest options into call prices. Such data still has arbitrage, hence we use a linear SANOS pre-processing step to obtain fitted prices within bid/ask which adhere to basic linear no-arbitrage conditions (the absence of which would indicate actionable arbitrage). We drop any strikes where such a fit cannot be achieved, assuming that fit issues are due to data alignment challenges rather than genuine trading opportunities.

A.2 Raw Daily Market Data

For every eligible date d, the underlying data contain quantities such as

- the SPX spot price S_d and previous spot price S_{d-1};
- option strikes and expiration dates; call and put bid and ask quotes; volume and open interest; AM/PM settlement indicators;
- forward and discount-curve information (with forwards being re-calculated below).

The default raw-data cleaning removes

- same-day expirations;
- options with bids below 0.011 (the minimum tick size is 0.05\$ for series trading below 3\$);
- observations with missing or invalid quotes; observations with an invalid settlement flag; irregular expirations; dates or ticker-date combinations known to contain bad data (e.g. 2025-01-08 which was a holiday).

A.3 Enrichment and Expiry Filtering

The cleaned quotes are enriched with

- business days and year fractions to expiry where AM options are counted as 20% of the day;
- implied forward prices computed off put-call parity per expiry for all strikes for which both call and put were traded and have valid bid/ask prices and sizes, weighted by put-call implied forward bid-ask spread.[8]

[8] We compute $\text{fwd}^{\text{ask}}(K) := +\text{Call}^{\text{ask}} - \text{Put}^{\text{bid}} - \text{df}K$ and $\text{fwd}^{\text{bid}}(K) := +\text{Call}^{\text{bid}} - \text{Put}^{\text{ask}} - \text{df}K$ using the discount factor sourced from IvyDB. Then we define $\text{fwd}^{\text{mid}}(K) := 0.5\,(\text{fwd}^{\text{ask}}(K) + \text{fwd}^{\text{bid}}(K))$ and $\gamma^{\text{mid}}(K) := 0.5\,(\text{fwd}^{\text{ask}}(K) - \text{fwd}^{\text{bid}}(K))$ and

$$\text{fwd} := \frac{\sum_K \gamma(K)^{-1}\text{fwd}^{\text{mid}}(K)}{\sum_K \gamma(K)^{-1}}$$

- using the new forward, define "market" mid call prices between the actual call prices and synthetic call prices from the puts;
- compute implied volatilities; forward- and discount-adjusted prices, strikes, and Greeks.

An expiration is retained only if it satisfies the default liquidity and quality requirements. In particular,

- at least 10 strikes must have either a traded call or put;
- at least 4 strikes must have both a traded call and put;
- the discounted forward normalized spread must be at least 10^{-6};
- implied volatility must lie in
$$0.01 \leq \sigma^{\text{impl}} \leq 5.$$

A.4 Arbitrage-Free Preprocessing

Before the final option filter is applied, an arbitrage-free representation of the daily market is constructed using [BHK+26]. The default configuration uses surface mode and performs the following operations:

1. Extend the strike grid to improve boundary treatment.
2. Fit a linear (DLV) no-arbitrage option-price curve separately for each expiry.
3. Drop expiries for which a valid fit cannot be obtained.[9]
4. Remove locally redundant strikes associated with negligible fitted density.
5. Fit a surface across strike and expiry to control both butterfly and calendar arbitrage.

At least five strikes per expiry are required. The default minimum fitted density is 10^{-4}, and the minimum admissible ATM volatility is 0.05.

A.5 Option Filtering

The empirical analysis retains observations satisfying

$$\text{BDTE} \leq 70,$$

where BDTE denotes business days to expiry.

The normalized-moneyness filter is

$$-3 \leq z_{\text{ATM}} \leq 2,$$

where z_{ATM} is normalized moneyness computed using the arbitrage-free fitted ATM volatility for the corresponding expiry.

Additional requirements are

$$\begin{aligned} \text{VegaSqrtVar} &\geq 10^{-3}, \\ \log(\text{volume}) &\geq 1, \\ \log(\text{open interest}) &\geq 1. \end{aligned}$$

Here, "VegaSqrtVar" refers to Vega divided by sqrt of expiry. It is therefore the sensitivity to total volatility of the option.

[9] Existence of such a fit is equivalent to the market not having actionable arbitrage using bid/asks as quoted.

Each retained expiry must contain at least 10 options.

It should be noted that this filter removes many options post 1Y for the early years of the training period due to the minimum volume traded filter. We suspect that this information in IvyDB is not reliable in the past. Future tests might want to remove the volume and/or open interest filters. (It is an option in our data pipeline parametrization.)

A.6 Spot Normalization

Price-like quantities are normalized by the current spot S_d to obtain variables of scale around 1. For example,

$$\widetilde{K}_d^i = \frac{K_d^i}{S_d}, \qquad \widetilde{C}_d^i = \frac{C_d^i}{S_d}, \qquad \widetilde{F}_d^i = \frac{F_d^i}{S_d}.$$

The original spot is retained as $\text{spot_ref}_d = S_d$. (The normalized log-spot level is passed on as h^0 later.)

A.7 Arbitrage-free preprocessing and model geometry

The preceding steps produce tradable normalized calls and puts with their observed bid–ask intervals. A per-date arbitrage-free SANOS fit supplies a smooth reference surface, an ATM-volatility curve, and an availability check for the retained quotes. The completed Direct-200 experiments do *not* resample this information onto a secondary reference grid. Instead, every eligible original quote enters the loss at its observed strike and expiry.

The decoder uses the two model-expiry geometries stated in Section 3.1.2: 14 weekly expiries from 5D to 70D, or the same weekly grid augmented by 1D–4D for a total of 18 expiries. On each date it builds one shared support with $N = 200$ inner strikes. Half of the normalized-moneyness candidates cover the first model expiry and half cover the final model expiry over $z \in (-3, 2)$. The candidates are merged and spaced, and the two boundary strikes are

$$\hat{K}_t^0 = \tfrac{1}{2}\hat{K}_t^1, \qquad \hat{K}_t^{N+1} = \tfrac{3}{2}\hat{K}_t^N.$$

The same support is used at every model expiry on that date; only the density and DLV coordinates carry an expiry superscript.

A.8 Fitting ML-SANOS

The native control first fits one unrestricted vector $u_t \in \mathbb{R}^{M(N+1)+2}$ to each date's irregular quote book. The completed affine model then uses the map

$$h_t \in \mathbb{R}^{200} \longmapsto u_t = b + Bh_t \in \mathbb{R}^{M(N+1)+2}$$

from (19). It is initialized from the native controls and then fitted jointly across all 891 dates together with the stable weekly state dynamics. Prices are evaluated directly at every observed quote; the training weights and inside-spread objective are those in (17).

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